

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	The importance and purpose of marriage for Jews: Jewish teachings about the importance and purpose of marriage in Jewish life, including Proverbs 18.22; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to the importance of marriage in society, including a lack of importance, cohabitation and the Jewish responses to them.
2.2	Jewish teachings about the nature and importance of sexual relationships: Jewish teachings about sexual relationships, including Genesis 1:26–31 and Song of Songs; divergent Jewish teachings and attitudes towards sexual relationships outside of marriage and same-sex sexual relationships; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to sexual relationships, including the acceptance of sexual relationships outside marriage and same-sex sexual relationships and Jewish responses to them.
2.3	Jewish teachings about the purpose and importance of the family: Jewish teachings about the purpose of family – procreation; security and education of children with reference to Psalm 127:3–5; divergent Jewish and non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) responses to the purpose of the family; different types of family within 21st-century society (nuclear, single parent, same-sex parents, extended and blended families).
2.4	Support for the family in the Jewish community: how and why the local community tries to support families, including through family worship, rites of passage, classes for parents, groups for children and counselling, with reference to Talmud Bava Batra 21a–b; the importance of the support of the local Jewish community for Jews today.
2.5	Jewish teaching about family planning and regulation of births: divergent Jewish teachings and attitudes about contraception and family planning, including reference to the Talmud, Yevamot 61b; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to family planning and the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Jewish responses to them.
2.6	Jewish teachings and attitudes towards divorce and remarriage: divergent Jewish teachings about divorce and remarriage, including reference to Maimonides, Mishneh Torah, Ishut 24 and arguments used to support or reject divorce; Jewish, non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to divorce and remarriage, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Jewish responses to them.
2.7	Jewish teachings and attitudes about the equality of men and women in the family: Jewish teachings and attitudes about the equality and roles of men and women in the family, including reference to Genesis 1:26–31; divergent Jewish attitudes about the roles of men and women in the family and Jewish responses to them.
2.8	Jewish teachings about gender prejudice and discrimination: Jewish opposition to gender prejudice and discrimination, including The Basic Law: Human Dignity and Liberty (1992 The Knesset); examples of gender equality in action in Judaism.

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	The nature and purpose of Jewish public acts of worship: the nature, features and purpose of Jewish public worship, including interpretations of Psalms 116:12–19; the nature, features and importance of synagogue services for the Jewish community and the individual.
3.2	The Tenakh and the Talmud: the nature, features, purpose and significance of the Tenakh (the written law) and Talmud (the oral law) for Jews in daily life today with reference to Perkei Avot 2; the nature and purpose of Jewish laws food laws, kashrut, including kosher and treifah and the separation of dairy and meat, including reference to Deuteronomy 14:3–10; the divergent implications of the Jewish food laws for Jews today.
3.3	The nature and purpose of prayer in the home and of private prayer: the nature, features and purpose of prayer three times a day; the importance of having different forms of prayers, including interpretations of Psalms 55:16–23.
3.4*	The nature and importance of the Shema and the Amidah (the standing prayer); when the Shema and the Amidah might be used, how and why, including reference to the Mezuzah; the importance of having the Shema and the Amidah for Jews today, including reference to Deuteronomy 6:4.
3.5	The importance of ritual for Jews today: the nature, features and purpose of birth rituals (including Brit Milah), Bar and Bat Mitzvahs, and marriage rituals, including interpretations of Genesis 21:1–8, Genesis 17 and Leviticus 12; the nature, purpose and importance of the mourning rituals of funeral, shiva, avelut and yahrzeit for Jews today; divergent understandings of the importance of each ritual for different forms of Orthodox and Reform Judaism today.
3.6	The nature, features, history and purpose of celebrating Shabbat: the nature, features and purpose of the celebration of Shabbat in the home and in the synagogue, including interpretations of Exodus 31:12–18; why the celebration of Shabbat is important for the Jewish community and the individual today.
3.7	Jewish festivals: the nature, history, purpose and significance of Jewish festivals; the origins and meaning of specific festivals, including Rosh Hashanah, Yom Kippur, Pesach, Shavuot and Sukkot, including interpretations of Leviticus 23 (Rosh Hashanah); divergent understandings of why festivals are important to different forms of Orthodox and Reform Judaism today.
3.8	Features of the synagogue: the nature, history and purpose of the different design of the synagogues in Liberal, Reform and Orthodox Judaism, including facing Jerusalem, layout of seating the Ark and the bimah and with reference to Proverbs 14:28; how and why the synagogue is used by the different communities, including reference to Exodus 27:20–21; how and why objects of devotion are used within the synagogues, including a yad, Torah Scroll, ner tamid and menorah.

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Jewish teachings about the origins and value of the universe: scientific explanations for the origins of the universe and Jewish responses to them, including reference to Genesis 1–3; the value of the universe in Jewish teaching; divergent Jewish responses to the possible view that the universe may be used as a commodity.
4.2	Jewish teachings about the value of life: how life is shown as special in the Tenakh, including reference to being created in the image of the Almighty as shown in Genesis 1–3; divergent Jewish teachings on the value of life; the significance of sanctity of life for Jews today.
4.3	Jewish responses to scientific and non-religious explanations about the origins of human life, such as evolution and survival of the fittest, including Genesis 1:26–31; the significance of the responses to scientific and non-religious explanations, such as evolution and survival of the fittest, for Jews today.
4.4	Implications of the value and sanctity of life for the issue of abortion: the nature of abortion; divergent Jewish teachings about abortion, including the Mishnah, Sanhedrin 4:5; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Jewish responses to them.
4.5	Jewish teachings about life after death: Jewish teachings and beliefs that support the existence of a life after death, including reference to Maimonides's 'Thirteen Principles of the Jewish Faith'; divergent Jewish arguments for life after death (remembered lives, paranormal, logic, reward, comfort and meeting loved ones who have passed on); divergent understandings of the significance of belief in life after death in different Jewish traditions.
4.6	Jewish responses to non-religious arguments against life after death: why Jews may reject arguments against belief in life after death (including as a source of comfort, lack of evidence, fraudulent accounts, social control), including Isaiah 25.
4.7	Implications of the value and sanctity of life for the issue of euthanasia: the nature of euthanasia; different Jewish teachings about euthanasia, including different interpretations of Judges 9:51–57; divergent Jewish, non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Jewish responses to them, including support for hospice care.
4.8	Jewish responses to issues in the natural world: Jewish responses to threats to the world, including pollution, global warming and the use of natural resources; Jewish teachings about environmental care, specifically stewardship and humanity's role as stewards, including reference to Psalm 24:1–3 and The Jewish Declaration on Nature – Assisi 1986; divergent Jewish responses to animal rights, animal experimentation and the use of animals for food, including the application of ethical theories such as utilitarianism.